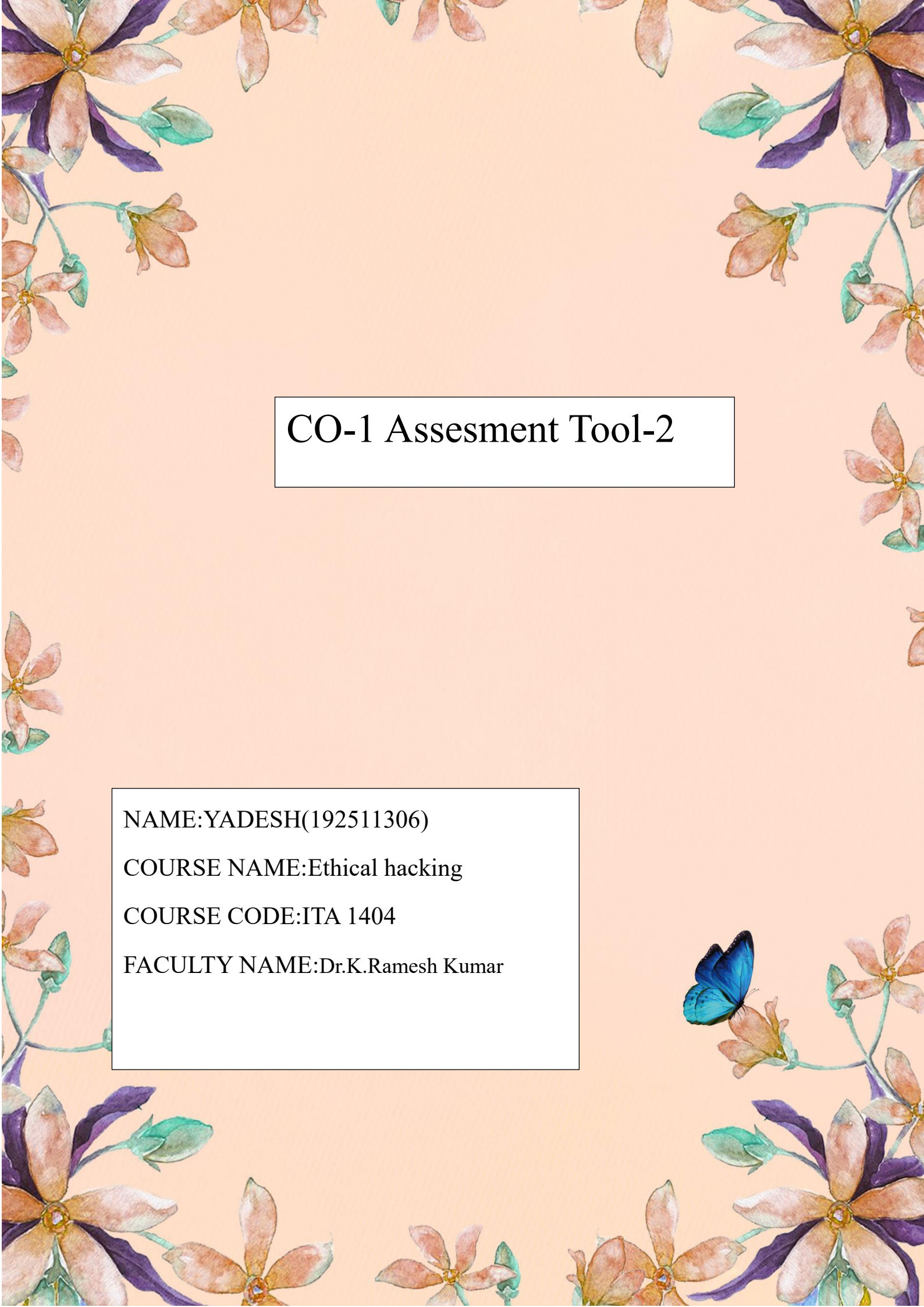




CO-1 Assesment Tool-2

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Ethical Hacking and the Legal System

As technology has become a part of our daily lives, cyber attacks have also increased. Organizations like banks, hospitals, schools, and government offices store sensitive information online. If hackers steal this information, it can cause financial loss and privacy issues.

To prevent such attacks, organizations hire ethical hackers. Ethical hackers legally test computer systems to find security weaknesses before criminals can exploit them.

However, ethical hacking is only legal when it is performed with proper permission. Without permission, the same activity becomes illegal hacking.

Ethical hacking is the process of testing the security of computer systems, networks, or applications with the owner's permission.

The main goal is not to steal information, but to identify vulnerabilities and help fix them.

Ethical hackers follow a structured process:

- Planning and getting authorization
- Scanning the target system
- Finding vulnerabilities
- Testing security weaknesses
- Reporting the findings to the organization

After the report is submitted, the organization fixes the issues to improve security.

Ethical Hacking and the Legal System

The legal system defines what is allowed and what is considered a cybercrime.

Ethical hacking is legal only when:

- The hacker has written permission from the owner.
- The testing stays within the agreed scope.
- Sensitive data is kept confidential.
- The discovered vulnerabilities are responsibly reported.

Without permission, actions such as scanning a network, accessing systems, or exploiting vulnerabilities are illegal, even if the intention is to "check security."

Many countries have cyber laws to protect individuals and organizations.

In India

The main law is the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000.

This Act covers cyber crimes such as:

- Unauthorized access
- Data theft
- Identity theft
- Hacking
- Online fraud
- Damage to computer systems

If someone hacks a system without authorization, they may face fines or imprisonment depending on the seriousness of the offense.

Ethical hackers work within the law, while malicious hackers violate these laws.

Importance of Ethical Hacking

Ethical hacking helps organizations:

- Prevent cyber attacks
- Protect customer information
- Improve system security
- Reduce financial losses
- Build trust with customers

Many companies regularly conduct penetration testing because preventing attacks is much less costly than recovering from one.

Conclusion

To conclude, ethical hacking plays an important role in today's digital world. It helps organizations identify weaknesses before cybercriminals can exploit them.

However, ethical hacking must always follow legal rules and ethical standards. Permission is the key difference between ethical hacking and illegal hacking.

By following the law and acting responsibly, ethical hackers help create a safer and more secure digital environment.

Thank you.

